



Alpine Linux

A comprehensive cheatsheet for Alpine Linux, covering package management, system administration, networking, and more. Alpine Linux is a security-oriented, lightweight Linux distribution based on musl libc and busybox.



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Alpine Linux Cheatsheet

Package Management (apk)

Basic Package Operations

```
# Update package index
apk update
```

```
# Upgrade all installed packages
apk upgrade
```

```
# Install a package
apk add <package-name>
```

```
# Remove a package
```

```
apk del <package-name>
```

```
# Search for a package
```

```
apk search <package-name>
```

```
# Show package info
```

```
apk info <package-name>
```

```
# List all installed packages
```

```
apk list --installed
```

Advanced Package Operations

```
# Add package from testing repository
```

```
apk add --no-cache --repository http://dl-  
cdn.alpinelinux.org/alpine/edge/testing <package-name>
```

```
# Add multiple packages
```

```
apk add package1 package2 package3
```

```
# Clean package cache
```

```
apk cache clean
```

System Administration

Service Management (OpenRC)

```
# Start a service
```

```
rc-service <service-name> start
```

```
# Stop a service
```

```
rc-service <service-name> stop
```

```
# Restart a service
```

```
rc-service <service-name> restart
```

```
# Add service to default runlevel
```

```
rc-update add <service-name> default

# Remove service from default runlevel
rc-update del <service-name> default

# List all services
rc-status
```

System Information

```
# Show system information
uname -a

# Show disk usage
df -h

# Show memory usage
free -h

# Show running processes
ps aux

# Show system uptime
uptime
```

Network Configuration

```
# Show network interfaces
ip addr show

# Configure network interface
setup-interfaces

# Test network connectivity
ping -c 4 google.com

# Show routing table
ip route show
```

```
# Add a new user
adduser <username>

# Add user to group
addgroup <username> <groupname>

# Change password
passwd <username>

# Delete user
deluser <username>

# List all users
cat /etc/passwd
```

File System Operations

```
# Create directory
mkdir <directory-name>

# Remove directory
rm -r <directory-name>

# Copy files
cp <source> <destination>

# Move/rename files
mv <source> <destination>

# Change permissions
chmod <permissions> <file>
```

```
# Change ownership  
chown <user>:<group> <file>
```

Container Operations

Docker Support

```
# Install Docker  
apk add docker  
  
# Start Docker service  
rc-service docker start  
  
# Enable Docker at boot  
rc-update add docker default
```

System Maintenance

```
# Check disk space
df -h

# Check directory size
du -sh <directory>

# Mount a device
mount /dev/<device> /mnt/<mountpoint>

# Unmount a device
umount /mnt/<mountpoint>
```

```
# Create tar archive
tar -czf backup.tar.gz /path/to/backup

# Extract tar archive
tar -xzf backup.tar.gz

# Create system backup (root required)
lbu package /media/backup.apkovl.tar.gz
```

Tips and Tricks

- /etc/apk/repositories - Package repositories
- /etc/network/interfaces - Network configuration
- /etc/hostname - System hostname
- /etc/hosts - Host mappings

- /etc/resolv.conf - DNS configuration

Environment Variables

```
# Set environment variable
export VARIABLE=value

# View all environment variables
env

# Add permanent environment variable
echo "export VARIABLE=value" >> ~/.profile
```

System Logs

```
# View system logs
less /var/log/messages

# View boot messages
dmesg

# Follow log in real-time
tail -f /var/log/messages
```

Security

Firewall (using iptables)

```
# Install iptables
apk add iptables

# Allow SSH (port 22)
iptables -A INPUT -p tcp --dport 22 -j ACCEPT

# Save iptables rules
```

```
/etc/init.d/iptables save
```

```
# Restore iptables rules
```

```
/etc/init.d/iptables restart
```

SSH Configuration

```
# Generate SSH key
```

```
ssh-keygen -t rsa -b 4096
```

```
# Copy SSH key to remote server
```

```
ssh-copy-id user@remote-server
```

```
# Edit SSH configuration
```

```
vi /etc/ssh/sshd_config
```

Troubleshooting

Common Commands

```
# Check system logs for errors
```

```
dmesg | grep -i error
```

```
# Check service status
```

```
rc-service <service-name> status
```

```
# Check system resource usage
```

```
top
```

```
# Check network connections
```

```
netstat -tuln
```

```
# Check disk health
```

```
smartctl -a /dev/sda # Requires smartmontools package
```


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